

Greek urban planning

The first historical figure to be associated with urban planning was the architect, physician, mathematician, meteorologist and philosopher Hippodamus of Miletus (498–408 BCE). His plans for Greek cities were characterized by order and regularity, with straight, parallel streets laid out in rational grid systems, and functions grouped together in certain areas (something rare at the time, since any invaders would be able to find their way about by following this logic). Hippodamus planned the cities of Miletus (opposite), Priene and Lyncus, creating neatly ordered and organized cities with wide streets.

Shrines, theatres, government buildings, markets and the agora (a central space where athletic, political, artistic and spiritual activities took place) were all grouped together in central zones, and land use was divided into the sacred, public and private (mirroring Hippodamus's division of the citizenry into three classes). Housing was the final area to be zoned, after all the other areas were allocated.

